

June

27



## Also on this day

**1898** Canada-born US adventurer **Joshua Slocum** became the first person to sail around the world alone, in a fishing boat called *Spray*.

**1905** The crew on the Russian battleship *Potemkin* revolted against their officers – the first step towards the 1917 Russian Revolution.

## Fancy flip

French motocross rider Tom Pagès stunned fans in Madrid, Spain, when he pulled off a gravity-defying bike flip – the world's first in a competition – to win the Red Bull X-Fighters freestyle motocross event.

2014



1871

## One currency

In order to simplify Japan's money system, the Meiji government signed an act to introduce the yen as its national currency, replacing the old system in which powerful land owners issued their own money.

## Born this day

**1966** **Jeffrey Jacob (J J) Abrams**, US filmmaker. Having found fame with the hit spy TV series *Alias*, Abrams went on to direct movies, including *Star Trek* and *Star Wars: The Force Awakens*.

## A worm welcome

2009

Using only a garden fork, 10-year-old Sophie Smith established a world record by "charming" 567 worms up to the surface of a small patch of land in 30 minutes, at the World Worm Charming Championship in Cheshire, UK.

